

Chapter 48-3

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Liang Xinzhou had ordered too much food; there was no way to finish it all.

When injured, Liang Shi's appetite would decrease. She picked at some dishes but couldn't eat much more.

She took a short video of the leftover food and sent it to Liang Xinzhou, then wailed: [Big brother, really can't finish it all, such a waste.]

Liang Xinzhou quickly replied: [Someone will feed these to stray cats and dogs.]

Liang Shi still said: [Really don't need to order so much for me!]

Liang Xinzhou: [Okay.]

Liang Shi was surprised at how agreeable Liang Xinzhou was, but she also thanked him for the trending topic matter.

Liang Xinzhou: [Rest well and recover. I'll pick you up tonight.]

Liang Shi: [...]

Pick her up?

She could be discharged by herself.

Liang Shi replied that it wasn't necessary, but Liang Xinzhou didn't respond after that.

Soon someone came to clear away the table full of food. When Liang Shi checked the trending topics again, she found that the entries related to Dongheng Group had disappeared.

It had to be said, the power of capital was still strong.

This incident was as if it had never happened.

When the hospital room quieted down, Liang Shi opened a mini-program and played two rounds of games.

The little character in the game was treasure hunting, and Liang Shi casually tapped around as entertainment.

When her thoughts were completely relaxed, she finally opened that photo.

Taoyuan County, Taozhi Village, Guo Xinran.

Liang Shi searched for this name online and found that this girl was very good at utilizing the internet and media.

Her Weibo ID was [Family-Seeking Girl Guo Xinran], with seventy thousand followers.

Her bio read: All departed loved ones become stars watching over me, so I must live well.

She posted one Weibo post every day, with pictures of mountain scenery and her home.

Her home was dilapidated—once it rained, the ground would be full of mud.

There were two pigs and over ten chickens at home. The roof was covered with withered grass, and the long-unrepaired house looked like a dangerous building, to a degree unimaginable for people living in big cities.

Every Weibo post by Guo Xinran was very positive.

If she posted at night, she would write: Hope I can see my family in my dreams, good night everyone.

Occasionally when she had emotional breakdowns, she would post: Missing my grandmother.

Many people would comfort her below.

Liang Shi scrolled through all of her Weibo posts, from the day she registered her account until one day she posted: Rest in peace. /candle

From that day began her family-seeking journey.

Her pinned Weibo post was her self-introduction:

[My name is Guo Xinran, from Taozhi Village, Taoyuan County, Guangming Province. I'm 25 years old this year. Unfortunately, it was only on the day my grandmother passed away that I learned about my background—turns out I was bought by my adoptive parents.

That year, they were working in Haizhou City. Because my adoptive mother had just miscarried and was diagnosed as unable to conceive, and my adoptive father extremely loved children, they bought me from human traffickers when I was just a few months old. At that time I was just a baby and naturally knew nothing.

After buying me, my adoptive parents chose to return to Taozhi Village. I grew up here from childhood, thinking this was my home and these were my biological parents. But when I was seven, my adoptive mother became pregnant, and their attitude toward me changed. One day I heard them say they wanted to send me away because one family couldn't support two children. I was very scared and ran to my grandmother's house, also in the village.

My grandmother was disabled—at sixty-three, she broke her leg falling while picking mushrooms on the mountain. My grandfather had passed away in his fifties, so grandmother lived alone with great difficulty. Because my adoptive mother was pregnant, I didn't dare go back and could only live at grandmother's house, taking care of my disabled grandmother.

But that year, my unborn little sister died because of my adoptive mother's poor health, and my adoptive mother also passed away. My adoptive father never remarried but developed a drinking problem. He brought me back home, and every time he got drunk he would throw things and hit people. I was very scared, so I ran back to grandmother's house again.

Grandmother was very good to me, and my adoptive father gradually came to live with us too. He was still the same, but because grandmother was there, I rarely got beaten. As the only laborer in the family, my adoptive father would give me and grandmother living expenses every month, so I was fortunate enough to attend high school, but father was unwilling to pay for me to go to university.

My grades weren't good because my foundation was poor from childhood. Although I worked very hard in high school later, I still couldn't reach the undergraduate cutoff. Not going to university was regrettable, but I was also grateful that I could stay by grandmother's side to take care of her during those years.

Grandmother's disability became paralysis, and she could only lie in bed waiting for care. My adoptive father, due to alcoholism, fell down when drunk and hit his head on a stone, dying when I was 23. From then on, only grandmother and I were left to depend on each other.

I had also complained about life and fate, but I was grateful to still have grandmother with me. But I didn't expect that this year grandmother would also pass away. Before she died, she told me about my background and gave me the jewelry my biological parents had put on me. To this day, I no longer hold hope of finding my biological parents, but seeing the human trafficking case solved in Dongling City that day, hope ignited in my heart again.

Whether or not I can find my biological parents, whether my parents still remember me, I've tried my best.

As long as I try my best, I won't have regrets.

I hope this world can spare me a little love—just a little love would be enough.

Written to my biological parents: If you see my family-seeking information and don't want to acknowledge me, that's okay. Just send me a message to let me know I'm not alone in this world.

I've grown up now and can work hard to support myself. I will become a positive and upward person.

I won't pester you—don't be afraid. I hope you're living well.]

The accompanying photos showed her golden Pixiu¹ necklace and her selfie.

In the photo, she was smiling and looked very sunny.

The third photo showed the chickens she was raising—the chicken coop was messy, but the filter made it better highlight this person's kindness and diligence.

This Weibo post was nearly a thousand words long. Liang Shi read it from beginning to end three times, and no matter how she looked at it, it didn't seem like something written by someone who had only graduated high school with poor grades.

It wasn't that she was being conspiracy-minded, but having stayed in the entertainment industry too long, which celebrity's Weibo wasn't ghostwritten?

Especially such emotionally manipulative text was usually written by marketing experts hired at high prices.

¹ Pixiu: A Chinese mythical creature, often used in jewelry and believed to bring wealth and ward off evil spirits